

An Uncertain Future for Videocon

Erstwhile promoter Venugopal Dhoot is in a messy situation and his businesses could go into liquidation. Of particular interest is the Ravva oilfield, in which his group owns 25 per cent stake

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PHOTO BY RACHIT GOSWAMI

► **THE ARREST OF** Venugopal Dhoot, Promoter of the Videocon Group, primarily known for consumer durables, once again throws open the fate of the business empire he once owned. Reeling under a mountain of debt, the fate of the high-profile group is now, at best, unknown.

Chanda Kochhar, ICICI Bank's former MD & CEO, allegedly misused her position and granted loans to Dhoot in 2009 and 2011. Later, the CBI filed a case against Kochhar, her husband Deepak, and Dhoot. The allegation was that Dhoot had invested in NuPower Renewables, a company co-founded by Deepak Kochhar, after having obtained the loans. In 2012, these loans were declared as non-performing assets.

In mid-2021, Vedanta group company Twin Star Technologies had offered ₹2,962 crore for Videocon Industries against admitted claims of ₹64,938 crore of the secured financial creditors. That translates to 4.15 per cent of the claims for all creditors and 5.33 per cent for financial creditors. The liquidation value of Videocon was ₹2,568 crore and the insolvency tribunal had



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THE ALLEGATION WAS THAT DHOOT HAD INVESTED IN NUPOWER RENEWABLES, A COMPANY CO-FOUNDED BY DEEPAK KOCHHAR, AFTER TAKING LOANS FROM ICICI BANK. IN 2012, THESE LOANS WERE DECLARED AS NPAs